

Steelstown Parish Newsletter

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 2nd August 2026

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 14:13–21 – The Feeding of the Five Thousand

The miracle of the loaves and fishes begins with **compassion**. Before Jesus fed the crowd, He first recognised their suffering and their need. His heart was moved by those who were tired, hungry, and searching for hope.

In our own busy lives, God gently calls us to notice those around us who may be lonely, discouraged, forgotten, or struggling. A simple word of encouragement, a listening ear, or a small act of kindness may become someone else's miracle.

The disciples looked only at what they **didn't have**. Faced with thousands of hungry people, they saw only five loaves and two fish. Jesus, however, asked them to offer what they already possessed.

God rarely asks us for what we do not have. Instead, He asks us to place before Him our time, our talents, our compassion, and our willingness to serve. However small these gifts may seem, He is able to multiply them beyond anything we could imagine.

Before distributing the food, Jesus lifted everything to His Father in prayer. This reminds us that surrender is not a sign of weakness or defeat. Rather, it is an act of trust. We all carry burdens that feel too heavy or situations that seem impossible, yet when we place them into God's hands, what appears insufficient can become more than enough.

Finally, the twelve baskets of leftovers remind us of God's overwhelming generosity. His blessings are never intended to stop with us but to flow through us. When we forgive generously, encourage freely, and share what we have with others, God's grace continues to multiply in countless lives.

Prayer

Lord, fill our hearts with compassion. Use the little we have to accomplish great things for Your Kingdom. Teach us to trust You completely, to surrender our limitations into Your hands, and to share Your blessings generously with all whom we meet. Amen.

Readings for Next Sunday

Sunday 9th August 2026

First Reading: 1 Kings 19:9a, 11–13a

Psalm: Psalm 85:9–14

Second Reading: Romans 9:1–5

Gospel: Matthew 14:22–33

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday

- St John Vianney, Priest

Wednesday

- The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major (Rome)

Thursday

- The Transfiguration of the Lord

Friday

- St Cajetan, Priest
- St Sixtus II, Pope, and Companions, Martyrs

Saturday

- St Dominic, Priest
-

Pope's Prayer Intention for August

For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities, often marked by anonymity and loneliness, we may discover new ways of proclaiming the Gospel, finding creative paths to build genuine Christian communities.

Prayer for Vocations

We pray for men whom God is calling to the priesthood.

Like Jesus in today's Gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the vulnerable or those most in need, but always reflect the compassionate love of Christ as they nourish His people through the Word of God and the Eucharist.

Parish & Diocesan Notices

Rosary on the Coast

Today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm

 Lisfannon Beach

Praying for **peace, Ireland and our unborn children.**

Everyone is warmly welcome.

Give Blood – Save Lives

The **Northern Ireland Blood Transfusion Service** will hold a blood donor session at:

Lisneal College

70 Crescent Link

Derry BT47 5FQ

Monday 4th August

- 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm
- 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm

 Freephone: **0808 553 4653** to book.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh

Monthly Healing Service

Today (Sunday)

- Rosary – **2.45 pm**
 - Mass & Healing Service – **3.00 pm**
 - Confessions – **2.00 pm – 5.00 pm**
-

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses are available throughout the year.

Please visit www.accordni.com for dates and booking information.

Monthly Mass for Sr Clare Crockett

Sunday 9th August

7.00 pm

Carmelite Retreat Centre
Termonbacca, Derry

Day of Healing & Prayer

House of Prayer, Clonfert

Saturday 15th August

Led by **Eddie Stone**

A bus will travel from **Letterkenny**, collecting pilgrims in **Ballybofey** and **Donegal Town**.
A priest will accompany the pilgrimage.

 **Contact: 086 393 6547**

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk

Saturday 8th August

9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Downpatrick

Guides:

- Martina Purdy
- Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

 **028 4461 9000**

Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Youth & Young Adults

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference

(Ages 18–40)

Saturday 29th August

9.30 am – 6.00 pm

De Montfort House
Morning Star Avenue
Dublin D07 VA03

Tickets available through Eventbrite (search **Embrace the Grace**).

Youth 2000 Summer Festival

13th–16th August

Newbridge College, Kildare

Young people aged **16–35** are invited to enjoy:

- Inspiring talks
- Workshops
- Daily Mass
- Music and Prayer
- Fellowship
- Free buses
- All meals included

Visit **youth2000.ie** or follow **@Youth2000Ireland**.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

3rd–7th August

12.00 pm – 4.00 pm daily

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14**

Faith, friendship, games, arts & crafts, adventure and prayer.

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Community & Charity

Mary's Meals

Annual Step by Step Walk

Sunday 9th August

12.00 noon

Starting from:

Sainsbury's Car Park

Strand Road, Derry

Walking the Foyle Bridge and Peace Bridge.

Everyone is welcome—even if only for part of the walk.

Mary's Meals currently provides a daily school meal to **over 3 million children across 16 countries.**

Please keep all participants in your prayers.

Family Carers Ireland

Remote one-to-one support clinics are available **every Tuesday throughout August.**

Carers can speak privately from the comfort of their own homes.

 086 836 3842

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Pro-Life Events

Donegal Pro Life Church Gate Collection

Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August

Countywide Collection

Volunteers are greatly appreciated.

 Margaret:
00353 89 246 9599

Míle buíochas.

Monthly Pro-Life Witness

Friday 7th August
1.00 pm – 2.00 pm

Roundabout at Letterkenny University Hospital.

Everyone welcome.

Pilgrimages

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Support Station Island and help preserve this special place of pilgrimage for future generations.

Tickets

- Single: **€10**
- Book of 6: **€50**

Those returning a full book will also be entered into the **Early Bird Draw on 28th August 2026.**

Main Draw

23rd October 2026

Prizes

 €10,000

 €5,000

 €2,000

4th – €1,500

5th – €1,000

6th – €500

Lough Derg Day Retreats

As the Three-Day Pilgrimage season concludes (final day to begin is **13th August**), Day Retreats resume on:

- August: **18, 22, 23, 29 & 31**
- September: **5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20**

Take time away from the busyness of everyday life for guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal.

Advance booking is essential.

Employment Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

Clonmany Parish

The **Derry Diocesan Trust** invites applications for the position of:

Administrative & Financial Officer

Hours: 9 per week

Application packs are available from:

Bishop's House
St Eugene's Cathedral
Derry BT48 9AP

 028 7126 2302

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Closing Date: Tuesday **11th August 2026**

Publications

Reflections Through Poetry

A beautiful collection by **Fr John P. Forbes**

Available from the **Pastoral Office**

Price: £10

All proceeds support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for the Canonisation of Sr Clare Crockett**.

Sharing the Good News

Read the latest weekly Catholic e-zine featuring news, reflections and resources from across Ireland.

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/**.

Closing Prayer

May the Lord bless us with compassionate hearts, generous spirits, and unwavering trust in His providence. May we recognise Christ in those around us, offer Him the little we possess, and witness His abundant blessings multiplying in our families, our parish, and our community.

May Almighty God bless you, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Amen.